

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

SUPREME COURT

Justices back law that bans TikTok

Statute takes effect beginning Sunday unless app sold by China-based owner

By Mark Sherman
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court on Friday unanimously upheld the federal law banning TikTok

beginning Sunday unless it's sold by its China-based parent company, holding that the risk to national security posed by its ties to China overcomes concerns about limiting speech by the

app or its 170 million users in the United States. A sale does not appear imminent and, although experts have said the app will not disappear from existing users' phones once the law takes effect, new users won't be able to download it and updates won't be available. That will eventu-

ally render the app unworkable, the Justice Department has said in court filings. The decision came against the backdrop of unusual political agitation by President-elect Donald Trump, who vowed that he could negotiate a solution, and the administration of President Joe Biden, which has

signaled it won't enforce the law — which was passed with overwhelming bipartisan support — beginning Sunday, his final full day in office. "TikTok should remain available to Americans, but simply under American ownership or other ownership that addresses the

national security concerns identified by Congress in developing this law," White House press secretary Karine Jean-Pierre said in a statement, noting that actions to implement the law will fall to the new administration.

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GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Hemp backers take to Capitol

Advocates gave to lawmakers in fight over regulations

By Robert McCoppin
Chicago Tribune

Hemp business owners sent a flurry of campaign contributions to key Illinois lawmakers this fall to ward off a feared shutdown of their industry, though it paled in comparison to the money that licensed cannabis companies have given over the years, state records show.

Hemp advocates gave more than \$30,000 to oppose a bill they said would have shut them down, and instead favored a bill to tax and regulate hemp but let them stay in business. Much of that money went to the campaign fund for House Speaker Emanuel "Chris" Welch, who refused to bring the feared ban to a vote without 60 Democratic votes.

But campaign donations from cannabis businesses have a much longer history. By comparison, ICANN PAC, which represents state-licensed cannabis interests, made few political contributions in 2024, although it has been a heavy contributor in the past. The cannabis political action committee has given at least \$287,500 since it was founded in 2018, and was especially active with contributions between 2021 and 2023 when various issues, including hemp regulation, were being debated.

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JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A LEGEND RETURNS

Former Cubs slugger Sammy Sosa is introduced as he returns to Chicago during the opening ceremony of the Cubs Convention at the Sheraton Grand Chicago Riverwalk on Friday. Sosa, who holds the team's single-season home run record and thrilled the nation as part of the great home run race of 1998, had been banished from the organization for decades following his confession to using performance-enhancing drugs and the discontent of some of his former teammates. Sosa publicly apologized to the team last month before making his appearance at the annual winter festival celebrating and previewing the upcoming baseball season. The convention runs through Sunday. **Coverage in Chicago Sports**

State lands federal grant for EV truck chargers

By Nara Schoenberg
Chicago Tribune

Public charging for electric trucks — including the largest semi-trailers — is on the way in Illinois.

The state has landed a \$100 million federal grant for the construction of 14 public charging stations for medium- and heavy-duty

trucks.

Located at strategic points along major truck routes, the charging stations will have a total of 345 ports — enough to charge up to 3,500 trucks a day, according to Illinois electric vehicle officer Megha Lakhchaura.

"Illinois can be a critical connecting node for (electric) trucks going across the

county," said Lakhchaura, noting there is already some charging infrastructure on the East Coast and in the West.

"This would be that critical node that helps trucks actually go across the country, north to south and east to west," she said.

Charging station locations will include the Chicago area,

Springfield, and the Metro East and Quad Cities regions.

Medium- and heavy-duty trucks are responsible for 21% of the country's transportation-related greenhouse gas emissions, although they account for just 5% of vehicles on the road.

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\$100M

Amount of federal grant money for the state that will go to the construction of 14 public charging stations, which could potentially service up to 3,500 medium- and heavy-duty trucks per day.



AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Young orators honor Martin Luther King Jr.

Aiden Marshall, of the Boys and Girls Clubs of Chicago, waits before making his speech Friday at Foley & Lardner LLP's Annual MLK Jr. Oratory Competition at The Drake hotel in Chicago. Marshall placed second in the competition.

Mother of boy slain in alleged Muslim hate crime meets Biden for 'human connection'

By Zareen Syed
Chicago Tribune

Hanan Shaheen, the mother of slain 6-year-old Plainfield boy Wade Alfayoumi — who was fatally stabbed in an October 2023 attack that drew hate-crime charges — met President Joe Biden during a visit to the White House as he wrapped up the final days of his presidency.

Biden spoke with Shaheen for about 10 minutes, said Maaria Mozaffar, an Illinois-based legislative attorney who accompanied Shaheen to the Oval Office on Tuesday.

"We understood the enormity of the moment, and we wanted to be able to deliver every sentiment and statement that the Muslim community would want to deliver," Mozaffar said. "It's important to understand that behind every policy and every decision and every political office is a human being, and we were not going to give up an opportunity to have a human-to-human connection."

According to police, Joseph Czuba — the family's landlord — allegedly stabbed Shaheen dozens of times outside her home and stabbed Wade 26 times

because of their Muslim and Palestinian identity.

At the White House, Shaheen and Mozaffar met first with senior administration officials before spending a few moments with Biden. Mozaffar chose to give Biden a Palestinian keffiyeh, an English-language Quran and a wood plank with a Biblical verse saying, "Do to others as you would have them do to you." The items go far beyond political headlines and news of the Israel-Hamas war, Mozaffar said.

She also handed him a

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■ Trucks carrying aid line up Friday on the Egyptian side of the Rafah border crossing into Gaza as Israeli Cabinet agrees to temporary ceasefire following initial delay. **Nation & World**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 29 Low 7

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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